

Paragraph Writing

Think of a burger as a Paragraph

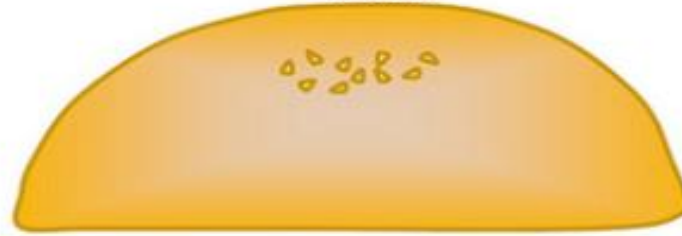


How?

Parts of a Paragraph

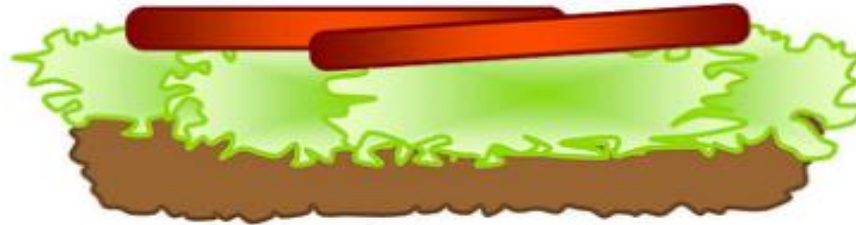
topic sentence

(top bun)



supporting details

(tomatoes, lettuce, and meat)



colourful vocabulary

(mustard, ketchup, and relish)



concluding sentence

(bottom bun)



How?

- Topic Sentence
- Supporting Details
 - Major Supporting Details
 - Minor Supporting Details
- Concluding Sentence

Topic Sentence

- First sentence in a paragraph.
- The **topic** then **what you want to say (controlling idea)/Stance** about that topic.
- Topic Sentence = **Topic** + **Controlling Idea**
- **Examples:**

1. People can avoid plagiarizing by taking certain precautions.

People can avoid **plagiarizing** **by taking certain precautions**.

2. There are several advantages to online education.

There are **several advantages** to **online education**.

3. Leadership requires specific qualities that anyone can develop.

Leadership **requires specific qualities** that anyone can develop.

Sample Paragraph

Miami is a wonderful place to visit. Miami has great beaches. You can go to South Beach, which is a fun, young exciting beach. You will see people playing volleyball on the beach and always having a party. If you are with young children, you will want to go to Hollywood Beach, as it is set up for kids with an amazing boardwalk and places for them to ride bicycles. Miami has incredible sporting events. You can catch the thrill and excitement when you go and watch the Heat win all their games. We also have the Miami Dolphins football team and the Marlins baseball team. If you enjoy tennis, then you can go to the Key Biscayne tournament, which is held every year. Miami has perfect weather. You can come to Miami in December and the temperature will be 75°F.

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Sample Paragraph

Assignment essay tasks are set to assist students to develop mastery of their study subject. Firstly, assignment tasks enhance understandings about subject matter. Yang and Baker (2005, p. 1) reason that “to master your learning materials and extend your understandings, you need to write about the meanings you gain from your research”. Secondly, students learn the writing conventions of a subject area while they are researching, reading and writing in their discipline. This activity helps them to “crack the code” of the discipline (Bloggs, 2003, p. 44). Thus, students are learning subject matter and how to write in that disciplinary area by researching and writing assignment essays.

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Online Activity

https://www.victoria.ac.nz/llc/llc_resources/academic-writing/index.html

Exercise 1.1

Exercise 1.2

Exercise 2.1

Exercise 2.2

Exercise 2.3

Exercise 2.4

Exercise 3.1

Exercise 3.2